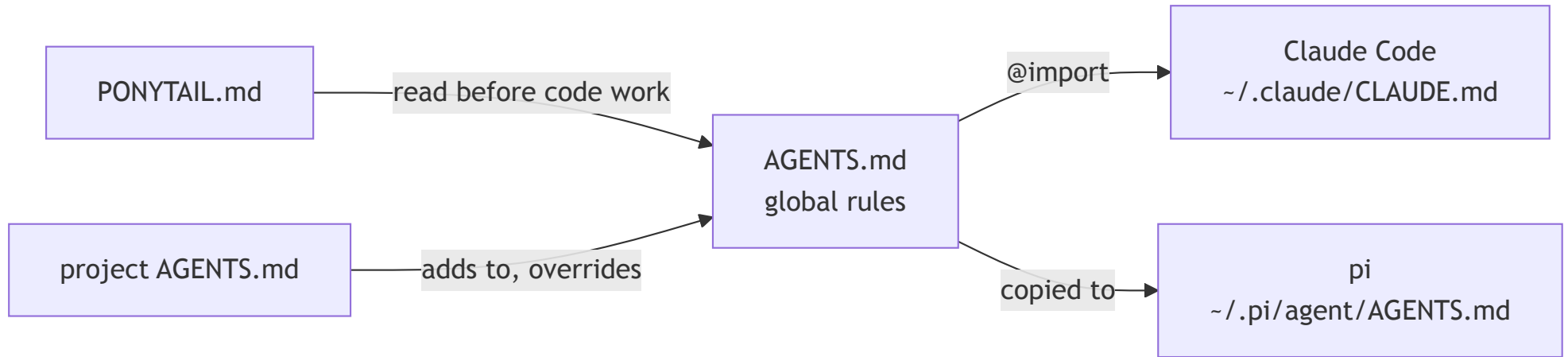


agents: the rules my coding agents follow

Two Markdown files that every coding agent I run loads at the start of every session. That includes the local Flash-Next model under [pi](#), and Claude Code.

- **AGENTS.md** sets how to work with me in any project: headline first, scope to the ask, list loose ends instead of chasing them, check in every ~10 tool calls, and explain top-down with small Mermaid diagrams that are checked to render, with a PDF shipped beside the Markdown (md2pdf). These rules matter more for a local model: at 20–30 t/s, every tool call it skips saves real time.
- **PONYTAIL.md** covers how to write code: the least code that works (YAGNI, then reuse, then the standard library, then platform features, and only then new code). It is vendored unchanged from [DietrichGebert/ponytail](#) (MIT); the front matter records where it came from.

A project's own `AGENTS.md` adds to these and wins where the two conflict. A project can opt out of PONYTAIL with `ponytail: off`.



Install

Claude Code reads `~/ .claude/CLAUDE.md` in every project, and `@path` lines in it import other files:

```
# ~/ .claude/CLAUDE.md
@/path/to/local-inference-setup/agents/AGENTS.md
```

AGENTS.md tells the agent to read `PONYTAIL.md` from beside it, so keep the two files together.

pi reads `~/ .pi/agent/AGENTS.md` as its global context. Copy both files there. Use real copies rather than symlinks if pi runs in a container that mounts only `~/ .pi`:

```
cp agents/AGENTS.md agents/PONYTAIL.md ~/ .pi/agent/
cp tools/md2pdf/pi-extension/md2pdf.js ~/ .pi/agent/extensions/    # optional: auto-PDF
```

Make it yours

AGENTS.md is written about me (“Mike”, “the user”). Change the name, and keep the rules that suit how you work. The “How the user learns” section describes my preference for visual, top-down explanation; replace it with yours.